UNIT III - CONVERSATIONAL SKILLS

1. Basics of Conversation

- **Greetings:** Good morning. Hello. How are you? Nice to see you.
- **Introducing yourself:** Hello, I am Ravi. I am from Puducherry. I am studying BCA.
- **Introducing others:** Meena, this is my friend Kumar. Kumar, this is Meena.
- **Asking questions:** Use wh-words (what, where, when, who, why, how) for information and yes/no questions for confirmation. Use polite forms: Could you tell me...? Would you mind...?
- **Responding:** Give a full, polite answer and ask a question back to keep the conversation going.
- **Closing:** It was nice talking to you. See you soon. Take care.

Sample Dialogue
A: Good morning! I don't think we have met. I am Priya.
B: Good morning, Priya. I am Arun. Are you new here?
A: Yes, I joined the college last week. Which department are you in?
B: I am in Computer Applications. Nice to meet you.
A: Nice to meet you too. See you around!

2. Describing People, Places, Situations and Events

- **People:** appearance (height, build, hair), dress, character, habits. 'My teacher is tall and calm. She always smiles and explains patiently.'
- **Places:** location, size, what you see, how it feels. 'Auroville is peaceful, green and quiet.'
- **Situations:** what is happening, who is involved, how people feel.
- **Events:** what, when, where, who, and the order of happenings (first, then, after that, finally).

Tip: Use the five senses and specific adjectives instead of general words such as 'nice' or 'good'.

3. Extempore Speeches

An extempore speech is given on the spot with little or no preparation. Structure it in three parts:

- **Opening:** A quote, question or short statement to catch attention.
- **Body:** Two or three main points, each with a short example.
- **Closing:** A summary and a strong final line.
- Use the minute of thinking time to pick the topic angle and the three points. Speak slowly, pause, and avoid fillers such as 'umm' and 'you know'.

4. Persuasive and Descriptive Speeches

	Persuasive speech	Descriptive speech
Aim	Convince the audience to agree or act	Help the audience picture a person, place or thing
Language	Strong, emotional, uses facts and reasons	Sensory, detailed, vivid adjectives
Structure	Attention - problem - solution - call to action	Overview - details in order (near to far, top to bottom) - impression
Example topic	Why we should avoid plastic	My village in the monsoon

5. Speaking Through Narration

Narration means telling a story or an event in sequence. A good narration has:

- **Setting:** time and place. **Characters:** who is in the story.
- **Plot:** beginning (introduction), middle (problem, rising action, climax) and end (resolution).
- **Past tense** and time connectors: one day, suddenly, meanwhile, at last.
- **Voice:** change pace, pitch and volume to show suspense, surprise or humour.

6. Narrating Stories and Describing Characters

- Begin with a hook: 'Last summer, something strange happened to me.'
- Describe a character through **appearance, speech, actions and feelings**. Show traits by what the character does, not only by labels.
- Describe the situation of the story: the conflict, what the character wants and what stops them.
- End with the outcome and, if suitable, the lesson learnt.